

# MAX MARCZINEK

PhD Candidate in Economics  
Department of Economics  
University of Oxford

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## Research Fields

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**Primary Field:** International Trade

**Secondary Fields:** Growth, Economic History, Labour

## Education

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### University of Oxford, Nuffield College

D.Phil. Economics

2021-

Supervisors: Banu Demir, Stephen Broadberry

### Humboldt University Berlin, Germany

Visiting PhD student

2025

Host: Gabriel Ahlfeldt

### University of Oxford, Nuffield College

M.Phil. Economics – Distinction & George Webb Medley Prize

2019-2021

Supervisor: Ferdinand Rauch

### Humboldt University Berlin, Germany

B.Sc. in Economics

2015-2019

### University of California, Los Angeles

Exchange Student, Economics

2017-2018

## Job Market Paper

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### Labour Scarcity and Productivity: Insights from the Last Nordic Plague [Latest Version](#)

I study the causal impact of labour scarcity on productivity growth, a key driver of long-run economic growth. Exploiting a natural experiment from a 1710s plague outbreak in Northern Europe, I show that plagued regions shift into capital-intensive exports and see an export expansion. Using rich port-level trade data and a Ricardian model, I trace this shift to productivity growth driven by capital deepening. While population levels recover within four decades, the productivity and trade effects persist for almost a century, suggesting long-run changes in comparative advantage. My findings imply that labour scarcity can induce productivity-enhancing reallocation.

*Winner of the FREIT-EIIT Award for Best Graduate Paper in Empirical Trade*

*Winner of the GSWG & Stiftung für die Wissenschaft Best Paper Award Economic and Social History*

## Publications

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**Networks in Trade – Evidence from the Legacy of the Hanseatic League** (with Stephan Maurer and Ferdinand Rauch) (previously my Master's thesis) [Published Version](#)

*Journal of International Economics*, 2025

## Working Papers

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**AI and Services-Led Growth: Evidence from Indian Job Adverts** (with Alex Copestake, Ashley People, and Katherine Stapleton) [Working Paper](#), [IMF Research Perspectives](#); [Ideas for India](#), [The Economist](#)

Revise and Resubmit at *Journal of Human Resources*

## Work in Progress

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**Industrial Policy and the East Asian Growth Miracle** (with Réka Juhász, Nathan Lane, and Kristen Yang)

**Useful Knowledge** (with Alexandra de Pleijt and Julius Koschnick)

**AI and Offshoring** (with Katherine Stapleton and Kristen Yang)

## Awards, grants, and scholarships

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**FREIT-EIIT Award for Best Graduate Paper in Empirical Trade**

Forum for Research in International Trade (FREIT)

2025

**Best Paper Award Economic and Social History**

German Economic History Association & Stiftung für die Wissenschaft

2025

**Add-On Fellowship for Interdisciplinary Science and Transfer**

Joachim Herz Foundation

2025-2028

**Scatcherd Scholarship**

University of Oxford

2025

**Department of Economics Bursary**

University of Oxford

2023-2025

**SSHRC Insight Grant (CAD \$70,000 with Réka Juhász and Nathan Lane)**

Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council, Canada

2023

**Oxford-Terence Gorman Graduate Scholarship**

University of Oxford

2021-2023

**CIDER Small Grant (CAD \$24,851 with Réka Juhász and Nathan Lane)**

Centre for Innovative Data in Economics Research, Canada

2022

**George Webb Medley Prize for the best thesis (proxime accessit)**

University of Oxford

2021

**Clarendon Scholarship**

University of Oxford

2019-2021

**Studienstiftung des deutschen Volkes, Stipendiat**

German Academic Scholarship Foundation, Scholar

2016-2021

**Henrike und Dr. Thomas Kurze Prize for best graduate in Economics**

Humboldt University Berlin

2019

**Economics Undergraduate Research Fellow**

University of California, Los Angeles

2017-2018

## Teaching

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**Department of Economics & Said Business School, University of Oxford**

Micro- & Macroeconomics (TA, Graduate)

2021-2024

International Trade Theory (TA, Graduate)

2024

**Department of Economics, Humboldt University, Berlin**

Introduction to Econometrics (TA, Undergraduate)

2024, 2025

Urban and Spatial Economics (TA, PhD)

2025

**Department of Economics & Department of History, University of Oxford**

Economics for Economic Historians (Seminar Instructor, Graduate)

2021-2024

**New College & Mansfield College, University of Oxford**

Microeconomics, Quantitative Economics (Tutor, Undergraduate)

2023, 2024

## Policy work

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**Berlin Economics & GET**

Consulted the Administration of the President of Uzbekistan on trade liberalisation

2025

**LSE Trade Policy Hub**

Researcher on papers for the UK Department of Business and Trade

2023-2025

**LUISS Hub for New Industrial Policy and Economic Governance**

Researcher for a White Book on Italian Productivity and Industrial Policy

2024-2025

## Service

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Co-convenor of the Economic and Social History Graduate Seminar  
University of Oxford

2021-2024

JCR (College Student Body) President  
Nuffield College, University of Oxford

2021-2023

## Conferences and seminars

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### 2025:

Empirical Investigations in International Trade (scheduled) (FREIT-EIIT, University of Tennessee),  
Pandemics & Society Seminar (OsloMet University),  
European Economic Association Meeting (University of Bordeaux),  
Workshop on Technology and Long-Term Development (University of Valencia),  
Urban Economics Association Conference (Humboldt University Berlin),  
6<sup>th</sup> Congress for Economic and Social History (Humboldt University Berlin),  
Economic and Social History of the Premodern World Seminar Series (Institute of Historical Research, London)

### 2024:

Empirical Investigations in Trade and Investment (EITI, Jakarta),  
Annual Cliometric Conference (American University, Washington D.C.),  
Spatial Economics Seminar (Berlin School of Economics),  
Royal Economic Society Easter School (University of Bristol),  
Urban Economics Association Summer School (University of Geneva)

### 2023:

European Economic Association Meeting (Barcelona School of Economics),  
World Congress of Cliometrics (Trinity College Dublin),  
Urban Economics Association Conference (Bocconi University),  
Danish Society for Economic and Social History (Copenhagen Business School),  
Transatlantic Doctoral Conference in Economics (London Business School),  
GEP/CEPR Postgraduate Conference (University of Nottingham),  
Economic and Social History Graduate Seminar (University of Oxford)

### 2022:

Urban Economics Association Conference (London School of Economics),  
Economic and Social History Graduate Seminar (University of Oxford)

## Languages and skills

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**Languages:** German (Native), English (Full professional proficiency), Dutch (Working proficiency), French (Working proficiency), Russian (Limited working proficiency), Italian (Limited working proficiency)

**Skills:** Stata, ArcGIS, LaTeX

## References

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### Banu Demir

Professor at University of Oxford  
[banu.demirpakel@economics.ox.ac.uk](mailto:banu.demirpakel@economics.ox.ac.uk)

### Ferdinand Rauch

Professor at St. Gallen  
[ferdinand.rauch@unisg.ch](mailto:ferdinand.rauch@unisg.ch)

### Réka Juhász

Professor at University of British Columbia  
[reka.juhasz@ubc.ca](mailto:reka.juhasz@ubc.ca)

### Stephen Broadberry

Professor at University of Oxford  
[stephen.broadberry@economics.ox.ac.uk](mailto:stephen.broadberry@economics.ox.ac.uk)